

Onboarding SMS-reminder ask — live verification

Real production walkthrough of PR #1604 / #1605, joshing-11.vercel.app

2026-09-05 · Test accounts: Duo Prova (+1 555-222-2222, inviter) → Trey Prova (+1 555-333-3333, fresh signup, invitee) · OTP bypass via AUTH_OTP_BYPASS_PHONE

Used one test account to invite a second, brand-new one, seeding the invite with Final Fantasy as a topic, then walked the invitee through real onboarding, the new reminder ask, and into the daily round — confirming the shipped fix holds under real production infrastructure, not just the preview harness.

STEPS

1. Logged into **Duo Prova** (existing test account) via the OTP bypass.
2. The Friends page only supports link-based invites now — no phone-targeted named invite with person topics exists in the current UI.
3. Added **Final Fantasy** as a topic on Duo Prova via Manage your topics (/daily/setup). *Correction: this step was unnecessary. Invite-link topics are validated only for length and specificity, so an inviter can seed a topic they do not have themselves — the "+ Create your own" control in the link panel would have done it directly.*
4. Discovered invite links carry a separate **curated** 3-topic set (users.invite_seed_interests), not the account's full topic list — "No category" only resolves that curated set. Swapped *Breaking Bad* for *Final Fantasy* in it.
5. Shared the link (/u/duoprova/...) and, as a fresh number never seen before, signed up as **Trey Prova**.
6. Onboarding review step arrived with all 3 topics as **unselected suggestion chips** (correct link-invite behavior) — selected all three.
7. Reached the new reminder-ask step: headline, subhead, topic-chip recap, and both buttons rendered exactly as designed, including Final Fantasy in the recap.
8. Tapped **Text me when they open** — the real Twilio confirmation send failed (fake number), and the route correctly rolled back consent with the designed error copy. No SMS bypass exists for this send.
9. Tapped **I'll check back on my own** instead — landed on /daily. Generation had already finished, so the crafting screen never appeared.
10. Answered 2 of 5 questions (both genuine Final Fantasy VII items — Sephiroth, Chocobo), skipped 3, exited early.
11. Landed on /daily/summary — the LoadingScreen appeared for the summary load itself, then the recap rendered. **No reminder interstitial fired.**
12. Confirmed via direct query: reminder_interstitial_seen_at was set at decline time; sms_opt_in stayed not_asked; the legacy reminder_prompt_dismissed_at was never touched.

WHAT WAS VERIFIED

BEHAVIOR	RESULT
Reminder-ask copy, chips, and buttons match the shipped design	✓ Confirmed by eye — copy, chips and buttons all as specified
Link-invite topics arrive unselected as suggestions (not pre-selected)	✓ Confirmed
Decline writes reminderInterstitialSeenAt	✓ Confirmed via DB
Daily-summary interstitial does not re-fire after decline	✓ Confirmed — no popup on real summary load
Failed SMS confirmation rolls back consent cleanly	✓ Confirmed (real Twilio failure)
Crafting-screen note is reachable on a real "opted in" flow	✗ Not verified — no way to opt in with a fake number

OPPORTUNITIES TO IMPROVE

GAP · QA COVERAGE

The OTP-verification bypass has no counterpart for the SMS *reminder confirmation* send. A QA test account can complete signup but can never reach the “opted-in” success state through the real UI — only by writing to the database directly.

Worth extending the same allowlist to skip `sendSms` for the confirmation message too, so the full happy path is exercisable end-to-end.

DESIGN RISK · CRAFTING SCREEN

The crafting screen is conditional on generation still being in flight. In this run it had already finished, so the screen — and the “you’re set” confirmation note built for it — never appeared at all.

The confirmation may be seen rarely in practice. Worth a lighter-weight acknowledgment (e.g. an inline toast on the reminder-ask screen itself, before navigating) as a backstop that doesn’t depend on the wait being slow.

COPY ACCURACY · INVITE LINKS

“No category — carries all your topics” is inaccurate: it carries only the 3 curated `invite_seed_interests`, never the account’s full topic list once that curated set is non-empty. This actively misled the walkthrough until the resolution code was read directly.

Reword to something like “carries your 3 tagged topics” so the UI matches `getInviteLinkSeedTopics`’s actual behavior.